

Diversiónary tactics

The last piece in the NVA's strategy was to lure American troops away from their strongholds in urban areas and along the coast by attacking American and ARVN outposts along the DMZ and in the Central Highlands. In addition to diverting US troops, Hanoi hoped to conjure up fears of the siege mounted on French forces at Dien Bien Phu in 1954, a siege so terrible that it had ended the First Indochina War.

In November 1967, US troops uncovered a communist document proposing a "general offensive." Astonishingly, it was dismissed by US intelligence agents as North Vietnam propaganda.



Misleading image

Hanoi maintained a public image of the involvement of General Vo Nguyen Giap (in blue) in the planning for Tet in order to obscure differences within the politburo.

“Above all, **we wanted to show the Americans** that we were **not exhausted.**”

GENERAL VO NGUYEN GIAP ON THE TET OFFENSIVE, INTERVIEWED BY STANLEY KARNOW
IN THE *NEW YORK TIMES*, JUNE 24, 1990